OFFICE OF
ASSESSOR-COUNTY CLERK-RECORDER & ELECTIONS
COUNTY OF SAN MATEO

RECEIVED
AUG 03 2026
TOWN OF PORTOLA VALLEY

MARK CHURCH
CHIEF ELECTIONS OFFICER &
ASSESSOR-COUNTY CLERK-RECORDER

Ballot Measure Primary Argument Submission Form

A ballot argument will not be accepted unless accompanied by this completed **typed** form, which shall contain the printed name(s) and signature(s) of the person(s) submitting it or, if submitted on behalf of a bona fide association of citizens, the name of the association and the printed name and signature of at least one of its principal officers. **Please make sure you are using proper format before submitting to the Elections Office.**

Word count limit for Primary Arguments = 300 words

Ballot Measure _____ for the Portola Valley Municipal Electi to be held on November 3, 2026.

☐ Primary Argument in Favor of ☑ Primary Argument Against

This argument is submitted by (check ONLY ONE):		
☐	**The County of San Mateo Board of Supervisors or the Governing Body of a School District or Special District**	
	Name of Governing Body:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Member(s) of the County of San Mateo Board of Supervisors or the Governing Body of a School District or Special District**	
	Name of Governing Body:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☐	**Bona Fide Association of Citizens** If this argument is filed by a bona fide association of citizens, the signers of the argument must be affiliated with the association and be authorized to sign the argument on its behalf. Provide the printed name and signature of at least one principal officer of the association.	
	Name of Association:	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:
☑	**Individual Voters Eligible to Vote on the Measure**	
	Contact Person's Printed Name: William Urban	
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]
☐	**Combination of Voters and Associations**	
	Contact Person's Printed Name:	
	Phone:	Email:

Arguments will be emailed to the contact person listed here for review before they are printed in the Sample Ballot & Official Voter Information Pamphlets.

Please complete the reverse side of this form.

40 Tower Road, San Mateo, CA 94402
P 650.312.5222 **F** 650.312.5348 **email** registrar@smcacre.gov **web** www.smcacre.gov

Primary Argument Signers Form	Author	Verified
No more than five signatures shall appear with any argument. If more than five signatures are submitted, the first five listed shall be printed. Names and titles listed will be printed in the order that they are listed below. Place a checkmark in the author column if the signer is the author of the argument. A signer can only list one title. Honorifics such as M.D., Dr., Esquire, etc. with a name are not accepted. If the signers are part of a bona fide association, there is no requirement that they be eligible to vote on the measure. However, for each such signing individual, the title under the signer's name must list the name of that bona fide association and may include their position within that association. By signing below, the undersigned state that they have read the argument and believe it not to be false or misleading. **Type** information clearly.	Check if the signer is the author of the argument. Authors must be signers.	(FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY) Staff check once the eligibility of the signer is verified.

1.	Name: William Urban	Title: Member, Portola Valley Finance Committee	☑	☑
Phone: [redacted]		Email: [redacted]		
Address: [redacted] Portola Valley CA 94028			Pronouns: He/His: ☑ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
Signature: [redacted]		Date: 8-3-26		
2.	Name:	Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns: He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
Signature:		Date:		
3.	Name:	Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns: He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
Signature:		Date:		
4.	Name:	Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns: He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
Signature:		Date:		
5.	Name:	Title:	☐	☐
Phone:		Email:		
Address:			Pronouns: He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
Signature:		Date:		

Submit a second form (this side only) for alternate signers attached to this form and the argument.

start
2 /**Vote NO.**

12 **This 1% real property transfer tax is unfair and inequitable across taxpayers.**

18 Only the 2-3% of residents selling properties each year would pay tax of $45,000 and up on an
15 average-priced home sale, while the 97-98% of non-selling residents and renters get a free pass.
17 Worse, if sellers leave town, they get nothing for those taxes. If they buy a replacement property
17 here, they pay a second transfer tax, plus suffer a regular property tax reassessment up to full
16 purchase price. How is any of this remotely fair or consistent with our Town's embraced value
2 of "community?"

99

12 **Town Council failed to provide exemptions** from multiple, separate transfer taxes for those
13 moving within town, or for distressed sale due to fire or natural disaster.

18 **This tax is bad economics**. A transfer tax, like a tariff, reduces net gain to seller and/or
15 increases price to buyer, thereby limiting both the number of potential buyers and realized prices.
13 Our home sellers compete for buyers against sellers in neighboring communities unburdened by
3 high transfer taxes.

74

13 **Enacting this tax requires conversion to a Charter Town, which is promoted as**
11 **maintaining "autonomy" and "independent status." But that's a false excuse, and**
11 **unnecessary**. There's no demonstration that the Town's existing autonomy and independence
6 ever have or will be compromised.

41

13 **Spending from this tax can't be restricted to voters' highest priority preferences, like**
11 **enhanced wildfire protection, public safety, critical infrastructure, or any specific voter**
13 **priority.** Council sacrificed such guarantees so they could lower the approval threshold for
8 passage to 50% +1 versus a two-thirds majority.

45

14 **Council neither asked for nor received an endorsement from its own Finance Committee** to
6 advance this measure to voters.

12 **There are better, fairer alternatives for additional revenue, and expense management, and**
5 **an imperative to explore them.**

2 **Vote NO.** / end

38

Total: 297